

TOP TRICKS — SUIT CONTRACT

The final contract is a suit partial or major-suit game. Your tricks are designed to MATCH the contract level:

- 2X — simple raise — 8 tricks (book 6 + 2)
- 3X — limit raise — 9 tricks
- 4M — game in major — 10 tricks

These are tricks you can take BY FORCE — no finesse, no promotion.

They come from three places:

- Aces and solid top sequences (A, AK, AKQ), cashed from the top.
- Trumps: you hold enough top trumps to draw them all without losing a trump trick, so your long trumps are winners.
- Ruffs: trumping a loser in the short trump hand.

The defense may cash a trick or two first, but once you are on lead you have enough top tricks to bring the contract home.

Things to think about:

- Count your tricks BEFORE you play to trick one.
- You can always make this contract without finessing or promoting — just cash winners, draw trumps, and ruff losers.
- At 4M, drawing trumps and running your long trumps is the plan.

Reference: <https://www.bridgebum.com/counting.php>